

INTERNAL — ARCHIVE 01

The care ritual.

Second-hand sells on presentation. The difference between ₹900 and ₹2,400 is rarely the garment — it's whether the buyer can picture themselves in it. Everything in this document is about closing that gap before the photo is even taken.

REWORN. — WORN ONCE. WANTED TWICE.

Before it is worth photographing.

A. WASH CORRECTLY, ONCE

— **Cotton & linen shirts** — cold machine wash, mild liquid detergent, gentle cycle. Never bleach a printed shirt (the Rare Rabbit print especially).

— **Knitwear** — hand wash cold, no wringing. Press water out flat between two towels, then dry flat. Hanging a wet knit stretches the shoulders permanently.

— **Vintage outerwear** — do not machine wash. Brush it down, spot-clean with a barely damp cloth, air it in shade for a day. Dry-clean only if it genuinely smells.

— **Coated / faux-leather** — wipe with a soft damp cloth only. Water and heat destroy the coating.

B. STEAM, DON'T IRON

— A ₹1,200 handheld steamer is the single highest-return thing to buy. It removes creases without flattening texture, and linen looks alive rather than pressed.

— Steam on the hanger, top to bottom, one pass. Let it hang 20 minutes before shooting.

— Iron only collars and cuffs, on low, from the inside, through a cotton cloth.

— Never steam directly onto a print or a logo — go from the reverse side.

C. THE FIVE-MINUTE DETAIL PASS

— Lint-roll everything, twice, in both directions. Dark cotton shows every fibre in a photograph.

— De-pill knitwear with a fabric shaver or a disposable razor held flat — this alone can move a piece a full health grade.

— Check every button; re-sew anything loose with matching thread before it falls off in transit.

— Trim loose threads with small scissors. Never pull them.

— Wipe zip pulls and metal hardware with a dry cloth — shine reads as "cared for".

D. STORING BETWEEN NOW AND THE SALE

— Outerwear and shirts on **wooden or padded hangers**, never wire. Wire hangers put permanent dents in shoulders.

— Knitwear folded, never hung.

— Leave a finger-width of air between hanging pieces so nothing creases against its neighbour.

— Cedar block or silica sachet in the wardrobe — humidity is the real enemy here, not dust.

— Keep everything out of direct sunlight; a week of afternoon sun will fade a shoulder line.

A phone is enough. The room is the problem.

A. FIX THE BACKGROUND FIRST

— Stop shooting on the bed. A patterned blue bedsheet is the single biggest thing pulling these photos down.

— Use one plain wall — off-white or pale grey. If there isn't one, a cream bedsheet taped flat and steamed smooth works.

— Shoot the whole archive against the **same** wall so the set looks like one collection.

— Clear the frame completely — no chargers, no hangers, no feet, no doorframes.

B. LIGHT

— Shoot 1–2 hours after sunrise or before sunset, indoors, **beside** a window — not facing it, not under the ceiling light.

— Turn every indoor light off. Mixing warm bulbs with daylight is what makes colours look muddy.

— Put a white bedsheet or cardboard on the shadow side to bounce light back. This is a free reflector and it does most of the work.

— Never use flash.

C. FRAMING

— Shoot vertical, 4:5. Lock exposure by tapping the garment, then pull brightness down slightly.

— Camera at chest height, phone parallel to the wall — tilting distorts proportions.

— Four frames per piece: full body, three-quarter, a detail (collar / buttons / hardware), and the brand tag.

— Stand about 2 m back and zoom to 2× rather than stepping close. It flatters both the garment and the face.

D. WEARING IT FOR THE CAMERA

— Never shoot a garment that doesn't fit as though it fits. Style around it — an oversized coat is a look, an oversized shirt tucked and belted is a look.

— Weight on the back foot, front knee soft, shoulders down, chin slightly away from the lens.

— Hands need a job: one in a pocket, one adjusting a cuff. Loose hands look nervous.

— Shoot 20 frames and keep 2. The keeper is almost always mid-movement, not posed.

The unboxing is part of the price.

A. PACKING

- Fold on tissue paper, not into a bag. Tissue costs almost nothing and changes the entire perception.
- One garment per bag. Kraft paper bag or plain mailer — no branded plastic from another shop.
- A single card inside: piece name, size, health score, and one line on how to wear it. Handwritten is better than printed.
- Outerwear travels on its hanger with the shoulders protected.

B. WHAT YOU SAY WHEN YOU HAND IT OVER

- Name the flaw before they find it. "There's a small snag on the left sleeve — that's why it's ₹1,000, not ₹1,600." Honesty is the whole brand.
- Give one styling instruction. People buy the outfit, not the garment.
- Never negotiate downward on a piece you've priced honestly. Offer a bundle instead.

C. THE KIT WORTH BUYING

Handheld steamer

~₹1,200 · the highest-return purchase

Lint roller ×2

~₹200 · one for home, one for the shoot

Cream sheet / roll paper

~₹400 · your studio backdrop

Cedar blocks

~₹300 · humidity control

Fabric shaver

~₹500 · rescues every knit

Wooden hangers ×10

~₹800 · shoulders stay shoulders

Tissue paper + kraft bags

~₹500 · the unboxing

Small scissors + thread

~₹200 · threads and buttons

Under ₹4,000 total, and it lifts every piece in the archive by roughly one health grade — which is worth several times that across a collection this size.